

with all four US and ARVN regiments involved in the eleventh assault on the mountain, the NVA finally withdrew into Laos on May 20.

About 600 NVA died in the fighting, and around 70 US troops were killed, with a further 370 wounded. These numbers were not as high as those from single engagements in 1968 during and after the Tet Offensive, but the NVA had taken heavy losses and been forced out of the pivotal A Shau Valley. Operation Apache Snow's objectives had been achieved, and US forces and those of the ARVN withdrew from Hill 937. Although the NVA moved back onto the hill, they would not use the supply route through the valley for three years.

“I’ll take a **court martial** before I go up ... again. It’s **suicide.**”

A 19-YEAR-OLD GI, INTERVIEWED BY UPI STAFFER BERT W. OKULY, MAY 1969



Temporary fixes

Medics attend to wounded soldiers during the heavy rainstorm on Ap Bia Mountain. The wounded were hooked up to saline drips (pictured) and treated with field bandages before they were carried on litters to waiting Medevac choppers.